BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #4 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

"I am a burden to everyone."

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Where it often comes from

Needing help with meals, driving, chores, or finances can make us feel like a weight on those we love. Guilt grows, and some people withdraw so as not to "bother" anyone. Often loved ones say they want to help, but the belief persists.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ," which assumes that all of us have burdens and all of us help carry them. Paul says "the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable" (1 Corinthians 12:22). Jesus welcomed those who needed help and said, "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened." Receiving care is a gift that lets others love.

> *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ"* (Galatians 6:2).

Also see

> "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable" (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest" (Matthew 11:28).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep" (Romans 12:15).

Common self-statements

- They would be better off without me.
- I am costing them too much.
- I should not ask for help.
- I am a weight on my family.
- They are tired of me.
- I wish I did not need anyone.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either independent or a burden.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will resent me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that I am a burden.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a burden.

Challenging questions

- What do my loved ones actually say about helping me?
- What would I feel if I could help someone I love in this situation?
- What do I still give to others?
- What does Scripture say about weaker members?

- How could I accept help in a way that lets others give?
- Who could I speak with if the thought of being a burden becomes heavy?

Truth summary

> I am valuable to God and to the people who love me, not because of what I do for them. Receiving help is part of how love works, and my presence is a gift. If dark thoughts come, I will tell someone right away.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Sickness
- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am a burden to everyone"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am a burden to everyone." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do my loved ones actually say about helping me?
- ☐ What would I feel if I could help someone I love in this situation?
- ☐ What do I still give to others?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about weaker members?
- ☐ How could I accept help in a way that lets others give?
- ☐ Who could I speak with if the thought of being a burden becomes heavy?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ Weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ Jesus welcomes the weary.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ Receiving is a gift to others.
- ☐ I am loved as I am.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."
- ☐ Matthew 11:28
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Receiving love: Each week, note one time you received help gracefully.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Galatians 6:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Weaker parts of the body are indispensable, and so am I.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Ask loved ones. Tell them what you fear and listen to their answer.
- [ ] Say thank you. Receive help without apologizing.
- [ ] Give what you can. Offer a prayer, a call, or a kind word.
- [ ] If you ever feel life is not worth living, call or text 988 (U.S.) now. Tell someone close to you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I am a burden to everyone": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Receiving love
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am a burden to everyone.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel like a weight on those I love. Show me that I am valued, teach me to receive with grace, and let my life bless others in ways I cannot see. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.